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(M___.0) ANDROMEDAN GRAVITY MINE

When the Andromedan Invasion of the Milky Way (R10.1E1) reached its Fourth Stage, the latest arrivals brought some new military technologies. Overall, the advances didn't have the dramatic strategic impact that, for example, the Neo-Tholian arrival bestowed upon that extra-Galactic empire; eventually, they became a footnote in the history of the Andromedan Invasion. One new technology brought by the Fourth Stage was a mine-like system that leveraged the ability of many Andromedan ships to carry satellite ships.

The Gravity Mine was first observed in late Y185 by the Klingons; between then and the destruction (U6.0) of the Andromedan Desecrator Starbase (R10.7), there was only one other confirmed use of this system. A number of hypotheses were floated attempting to explain the rarity; consensus seems to have formed around the idea that the Andromedans in the Milky Way galaxy were unable to produce significant quantities of Gravity Mines.

No other empire understands the operating principles of the Gravity Mine. In the event one is captured by another empire, it cannot be repaired, copied, charged, armed or deployed.

In terms of the game, the Gravity Mine occupies a strange place between the NSM (M2.0), a suicide shuttle (J2.22), and a Singularity Generator (G___.0).

(M___.1) DEPLOYMENT

(M___.11) PERMITTED UNITS: Only Andromedan ships capable of carrying a small Energy Module (G20.21) may carry or deploy a Gravity Mine; it occupies the same amount of hangar space.

(M___.12) DEFINITION: As with an Energy Module, a Gravity Mine is treated as a small Satellite Ship for most purposes; it is launched (and potentially recovered) in the same manner and for the same energy cost. Similar to an Energy Module, it does not complete Energy Allocation, is not manned and cannot move. Importantly, however, a Gravity Mine does not have PA panels.

(M___.13) DESTRUCTION: Aside from the lack of PA panels, a Gravity Mine is damaged in the same ways an Energy Module could be damaged, but it can only sustain 25 points of damage before it is destroyed.

(M___.131) If damaged but not destroyed, an active and armed Gravity Mine capable of doing so will trigger under (M8.42).

(M___.132) If a deployed Gravity Mine is damaged and for some reason does not trigger, then after it becomes inert (M___.22) it may be brought back aboard a properly-equipped Andromedan ship and repaired as an Energy Module could be. An undamaged inert mine may also be retrieved.

(M___.14) COST: A Gravity Mine costs 15 BPV and may only be purchased as a Commander's Option (Andromedan ships did not ordinarily carry one).

(M___.15) AVAILABILITY: In a campaign setting, or for the purposes of modifying existing scenarios, Y180 is the earliest an Andromedan ship could have a Gravity Mine.

(M___.151) There is no record of any Andromedan ship having more than one Gravity Mine at a time.

(M___.152) Purchasing a Gravity Mine does not count against the Maximum Load (M3.13) of transporter bombs for the ship.

(M___.153) There is no "dummy" (M2.9) version of a Gravity Mine.

(M___.154) The Andromedan Krait (R10.23) may not use a Gravity Mine in a tournament.

(M___.155) There is no record an Andromedan base having a Gravity Mine as anything other than cargo.

(M___.16) TACTICAL INTELLIGENCE: Unless identified (M7.5), until it detonates, a Gravity Mine appears to be a small Energy Module; although non-Andromedans, if they leave it alone long enough, may find it odd when the mine releases no energy from its (non-existent) PA panels. When attempting identification using labs (M7.51), minesweepers do not have the +2 bonus.

(M___.17) CONDITIONS: Gravity Mines are affected by (M2.2), except that an Andromedan ship with sufficient available hangar space may retrieve an inert (M___.22) Gravity Mine as if it were an Energy Module.

(M___.18) INTERACTIONS: A Gravity Mine does not uniquely interact with other Andromedan systems of the deploying unit, such as the Displacement Device (G18.0) or Singularity Generator (G___.0). An inert Gravity Mine may be "captured" under (G20.44).

(M___.2) ENERGY REQUIREMENTS

(M___.21) WARP POWER REQUIRED: To arm a Gravity Mine, the ship must allocate at least one point, and up to a maximum of three points, of warp power (from warp engines or warp reactors) to arming the mine, and do so for three turns. Fractional points may be allocated within the minimum and maximum limits.

(M___.211) Warp power allocated using Reserve Warp (H7.4) or Contingent Reserve (H7.6) could be used to arm a mine.

(M___.212) While it takes three turns to arm a Gravity Mine, the power allocations do not need to occur on sequential turns. However, the third turn of arming cannot be more than nine turns after the first turn of arming, or the energy of the first turn is lost and the second turn of arming effectively becomes the first turn of arming; the lost power is treated as "released" and must be resolved under (D10.424).

(M___.213) The mine may be deployed as early as the first impulse on the last turn of arming.

(M___.214) Once the mine has been allocated warp power for a third turn, it becomes "fully-armed", even if it does not have the maximum amount of energy (M___.23) that could have been allocated; no further warp power may be allocated to a fully-armed Gravity Mine.

(M___.22) HOLDING: A fully- or partially-armed Gravity Mine does not require power to maintain its arming state. However, once fully-armed, if the Gravity Mine is not deployed (or is deployed but is not triggered) within 10 turns, the arming energy is lost and the mine becomes inert. If this occurs during Energy Allocation and the mine has not been deployed, the

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power is treated as "released" and must be resolved under (D10.424). Arming may be restarted.

(M___.23) MAXIMUM ENERGY: The maximum power a Gravity Mine can hold is nine points; there is no way to put more than nine points of energy into the mine, nor will the arming system allow any attempt to do so. Also, the arming system will not permit more than three points of warp energy to be added to the Gravity Mine during a turn, even if doing so resulted in a mine with fewer than nine points of power.

(M___.24) WEAPON STATUS: If equipped with a Gravity Mine, an Andromedan ship at Weapon Status II may, at the owning player's option, have completed the first turn of arming with at least one and no more than three points of warp power. At Weapon Status III, the ship, at the player's option, may have completed up to two turns of arming with at least two and no more than six total points of power. Even at Weapon Status III, the ship may not end the turn prior to the first turn with a fully-armed Gravity Mine, unless a scenario explicitly permits it to do so.

(M___.3) OPERATION

(M___.31) PLACEMENT: A Gravity Mine is deployed in the same manner, and for the same energy cost, as a small Energy Module.

(M___.311) Gravity Mines are subject to (M2.6) if explosive mines are also subject.

(M___.312) Deploying a Gravity Mine does not interfere with the deployment of normal explosive mines using (M2.131).

(M___.32) ACTIVATION: A Gravity Mine activates under the same conditions (M3.223) (M2.3) as conventional explosive mines.

(M___.33) TRIGGERING: An active and deployed Gravity Mine is triggered using the same criteria as a conventional explosive mine. The criteria for triggering the Gravity Mine may be controlled by both or either of (M2.14) and (M2.15). Retrieving an active mine will also cause it to trigger the moment it materializes.

(M___.34) EFFECTS: When it "detonates", the Gravity Mine produces a spherical Gravity Wave (P9.4), centered on the hex occupied by the Gravity Mine.

(M___.341) The initial Force of the Gravity Wave is equal to three times the warp energy used to arm the Gravity Mine (if fractional arming energy was used, multiply the total energy by three and then drop all fractions).

(M___.342) The Gravity Wave moves (P9.2), damages units (P9.3), and diminishes (P9.42) as does a "normal" Spherical Gravity Wave. Note that the wave advances, causes damage, and then the Force is reduced.

(M___.343) Upon detonation, the Gravity Mine is destroyed, regardless of the amount of warp power used to arm it. If triggered by retrieval, the retrieving unit is also destroyed, regardless of the Force of the wave.

(M___.4) EXAMPLE OF OPERATION

An Andromedan Intruder, carrying a single Gravity Mine, enters into combat at Weapon Status I. During the first turn, the Andromedan player allocates two points of warp power to arming the Gravity Mine. On the second turn, she allocates two and ½ points more of warp power. During the third and fourth turns, she finds herself unable to allocate warp power to the mine; there is no "holding" cost, and at the end of the fourth turn the Gravity Mine still is charged ("partially-armed") with four and ½ points of warp power. The Andromedan doesn't allocate any power for charging during the fifth turn, but at the end she still has three points of Reserve Warp, and she directs those into the Gravity Mine when the turn ends. The Gravity Mine now has a total of seven and ½ points of power and is "fully-armed" (M___.214).

The tactical plane of the battle shifts and the Andromedan is unable to deploy the mine over the next three turns; she does not pay any holding cost, and the charge in the mine does not diminish (it remains "fully-armed"). During Turn #9, the ship deploys the mine. The enemy, assuming it is an Energy Module, immediately fires at it, during the inactive period (M5.1133), but only scores five points of damage; it remains operational and becomes active two impulses later.

The Gravity Mine is now active and fully-armed. If, before the end of the fifteenth turn, it was damaged (but not destroyed), it would detonate (M8.42) immediately; if it was not otherwise triggered, then the energy charge would be lost and the mine would become inert.

However, in this scenario, an Advanced Admin shuttle, launched by the enemy and moving at speed 7, triggers the mine during Impulse #8 of the tenth turn. The resultant Gravity Wave is initially Force 22 (7.5 x 3 = 22.5, then drop fractions). The shuttle is one hex away from the mine; the enemy ship is four hexes away, passing the mine (which had appeared as a small Energy Module) at an oblique angle (following movement, the mine is on the enemy ship's #5 shield) and moving at speed 14. On Impulse #9, the Gravity Wave advances; the shuttle does not move that impulse, so it sustains 22 points of damage (M___.34) and is destroyed. The enemy ship also does not move, and the Gravity Wave ends the impulse three hexes from the ship and at Force 21.

On Impulse #10, the Gravity Wave advances; the enemy ship (which has not yet satisfied its turn mode), side-slips away from it. The Gravity Wave is now at Force 20 and remains three hexes from the enemy ship. During Impulse #11 the enemy ship does not move; the Gravity Wave advances to two hexes from the ship, now at Force 19. On Impulse #12, the enemy ship, now unable to turn or side-slip, moves forward; the Force 18 Gravity Wave is now one hex from the ship.

Finally, the Gravity Wave hits the enemy ship at Force 18 during Impulse #13, when the ship doesn't move. After movement, the Gravity Wave is reduced to Force 17.

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